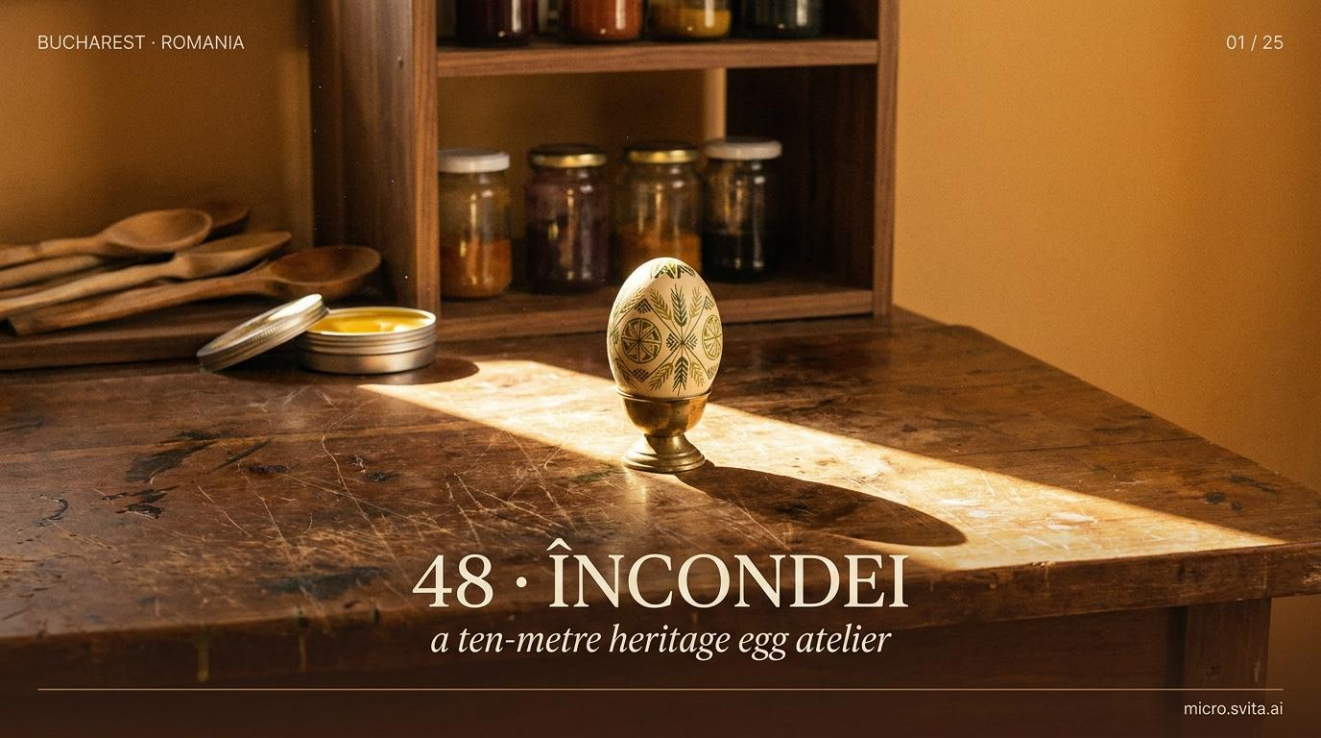


48 · ÎNCONDEI

a ten-metre heritage egg atelier

A heritage craft studio where every egg is finished by one pair of hands.

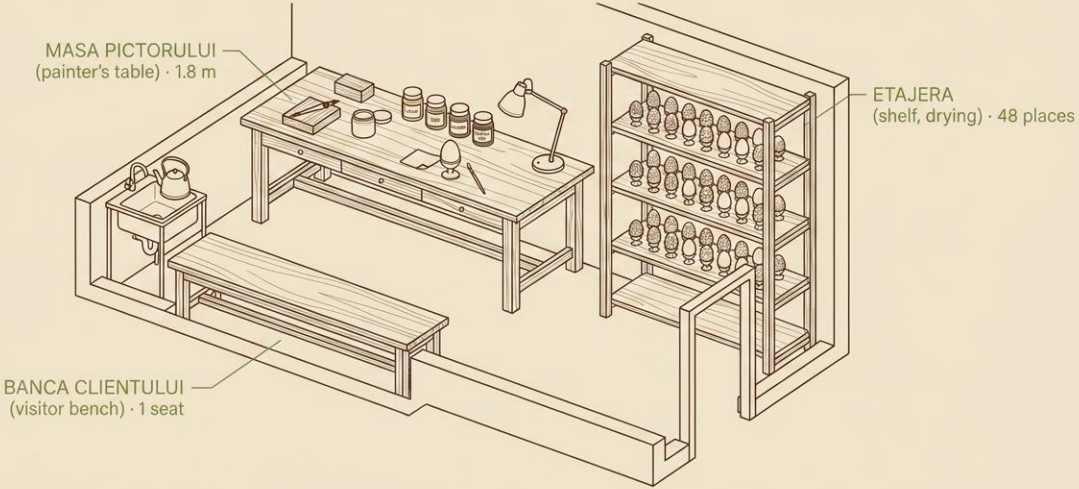
Încondeiate is the Romanian technique of writing wax lines onto a living shell, then dyeing in layers. Wedding eggs. Newborn eggs. Keepsake eggs.

Ten square metres. One painter. One table. Four natural dyes. No production line.

48 · ÎNCONDEI · BUCHAREST

FLOORPLAN · AXONOMETRIC

Ten square metres, four natural dyes, one pair of hands.



Announce yourself softly. The sign is smaller than the door.

0:01 · She reads the sign.

0:08 · She is seated. No words.

MATERIALS

Everything here has a Romanian name.

CEARĂ · beeswax

CHIȘIȚĂ · wax stylus

OCRU · ochre dye

COAJĂ DE NUC · walnut shell dye

OUĂ · village eggs

Six acts. Ninety minutes. One egg.

I · SPĂLAT — the egg is washed.

II · ÎNCEPUT — the first line is drawn.

III · CEARĂ — hot wax writes the pattern.

IV · BAIA — ochre for the first layer.

V · FLACĂRĂ — the wax is lifted off.

VI · ODIHNĂ — the egg rests.

SUN WHEEL

WHEAT SHEAF

TRIGRAM

FIR BRANCH

OAK LEAF

RAM HORN

WATER WAVE

SPINDLE

ROSE

THE VOCABULARY

Nine signs, older than the country.

Every encondi'ate motif carries a word. Sun, harvest, water, horn. A customer who asks for 'rose' asks for love; 'oak leaf' for a long life. We ask what the egg is for. Then we choose.

48 · ÎNCONDEI

Five eggs, five occasions.

EQUIVALENT · €32–80 · PAID IN LEI

OU SIMPLU · a single finished heritage egg	160 lei
OU DE NUNTĂ · a wedding egg, bride & groom motif	280 lei
OU DE BOTEZ · a newborn egg with the child's name	320 lei
OU DE POMANĂ · a memorial egg for the forty days	260 lei
OU CUSTOM · your motif, your story	from 400 lei

Every egg is begun in front of you. Collection in seven to nine days.

THE BOX

Box. Wool. Ribbon. Proof.

Every egg leaves in an unbleached pine box, nested in local wool, tied in linen, sealed with a walnut-ink certificate. The painter signs it. You carry it home like a prayer.

Four quiet marks of the hand.

STREET SIGN · enamel on walnut

HANGTAG · brass, hand-stamped

STREET SIGN · enamel, on walnut

DUST BAG · linen, ochre ink

WAX SEAL · walnut ink, ÎC monogram

Six primitives. One hand.

48 · ÎNCONDEI

PRIMARY LOCK-UP

MONOGRAM

HOUSE MOTIF

#D4A679 AMBER	#5C3A2E WALNUT	#7A8B4F SAGE	#F0E4CF BONE	#3A4F3A FOREST

PALETTE

PLAYFAIR — display

INTER — text

TYPOGRAPHY

Slow.
Warm.
Hand-bound.

VOICE

Small room. Honest sums.

24 EGGS PAINTED / WEEK	95 AVG TICKET · LEI · €19	9,100 REVENUE / MONTH · LEI · €1,820
29% NET MARGIN	2,640 PAINTER TAKE-HOME / MONTH · LEI · €530	8 BREAK-EVEN · MONTHS

24 eggs a week · 29% margin · 8 months to break even

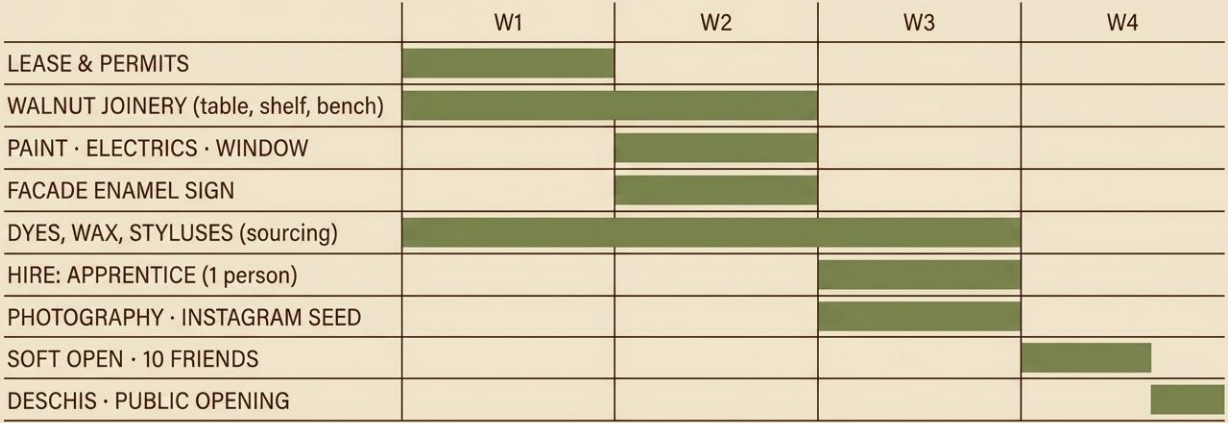
Ten square metres, costed line by line.

MASA PICTORULUI · painter's table (walnut, commissioned)	3,200 lei
ETAJERA · open drying shelf (walnut, 48 places)	2,100 lei
BANCĂ CLIENT · visitor bench	900 lei
LAMPĂ · tin lamp + brass cradles (×6)	820 lei
CHIȘIȚĂ · wax styluses (×3) + brass tips	420 lei
BORCANE · jars + natural dyes (first year)	600 lei
CUPTOR DE CEARĂ · wax warmer (artisanal)	1,300 lei
SEMNE · enamel facade sign + brass hangtags	1,800 lei
AMENAJARE · fit-out · paint · electrics	5,400 lei
CUTIE · pine boxes (100 pcs)	1,100 lei
LICENȚE · licences · launch content	1,360 lei
TOTAL	**19,000 lei · €3,800**

19,000 lei

Everything in the room costs less than one second-hand car.

Four weeks from lease to lamp.



No pre-paid stock. Dye first batch in week three. First public egg painted on opening day.

THE HAND BEHIND IT

Mariana Ionescu · painter · founder

Twenty-two years painting încondeiate in her grandmother's village in Bucovina, now six years in Bucharest. Every egg on the shelf is hers.

One 0.5 FTE apprentice joining in month six, to learn — not to replace.

1.0 FTE · FOUNDER + PAINTER
0.5 FTE · APPRENTICE (from M6)
EXTERNAL · COURIER · OCCASIONAL

48 · ÎNCONDEI

She walks out carrying a small box. Inside, a word written in wax.

Three people who already come.

Ana Popa

ART DIRECTOR · 32 · BUCHAREST

buys for a wedding

Wants a wedding egg no guest can duplicate. Visited once, ordered three weeks ahead. Pays in lei, no haggling.

first purchase: OU DE NUNTĂ

Sebastian Radu

ARCHITECT · 45 · CLUJ → BUCHAREST

buys for his mother

Found the atelier on Google Maps under 'Romanian heritage'. Ordered a rose-motif egg and waited a week. Came back for the wax seal himself.

first purchase: OU SIMPLU · ROSE

Sophie Braun

DESIGN STUDENT · 28 · BERLIN

buys for herself

Read a longform piece about încondeiate. Walked in on Saturday, sat for 12 minutes, watched, took the ochre one. Followed @48incondei.

first purchase: OU SIMPLU · SUN WHEEL

Four channels. None of them paid.

INSTAGRAM · @48incondei

one egg a day, no promotion. Six months of slow growth to 5,000 followers.

GOOGLE MAPS · LOCAL SEARCH

under 'heritage craft Bucharest' · Saturdays walk-in

PRESS · LONGFORM FEATURES

Dilema Veche · Scena9 · Kinfolk. One longform per quarter.

HAND-TO-HAND

every wedding egg goes to a wedding with 120 guests.

Three honest risks. Three patient answers.

RISK	ANSWER
Painter injury or burn-out — only one pair of hands.	0.5 FTE apprentice from month six. Two-week rest built into every quarter.
Tourist seasonality — Bucharest slows between November and March.	Winter pivot to memorial eggs (OU DE POMANĂ) — steady Romanian demand year-round.
Counterfeit machine-printed eggs sold sold cheaper.	Live-painting window sessions + signed wax seal + 7-day collection — the machine cannot wait in front of you.

We paint one egg at a time.

Because the chicken laid one at a time.

We use four dyes, one wax, one hand.

Because that was enough for grandmothers.

We do not ship same-day.

The wax needs to cool, the dye needs to wait, the memory needs to settle.

We sign every egg.

Because an unsigned egg is just a shell.

WRITTEN IN THE ATELIER · AUTUMN 2026 · BUCHAREST

What you buy from micro.svita.ai.

CONCEPT

€49

the paper version

- 25-page PDF brandbook (this document)
- Unit economics (eggs/week · ticket · margin)
- CAPEX line-by-line in lei
- 4-week timeline
- Three-persona customer map
- Supplier shortlist for Romania

DELIVERED IN 48 HOURS · PDF

EXCLUSIVE

€149

the hand-held version

- Everything in Concept
- Sold once — never resold to anyone else
- Editable source files (Figma, brand tokens)
- Transferable ownership (one change allowed)
- 30-minute founder call with svita team
- First-refusal on future Bucharest expansions

DELIVERED IN 7 DAYS · SOURCE + CALL

48 · ÎNCONDEI

One table. One hand. One egg. Yours to open.

Book the call.

micro.svita.ai / 48-bucharest-eggcraft

CONCEPT · €49

EXCLUSIVE · €149

see slide 23 · the manifesto